

THE 3 EXERCISE CHALLENGE

You don't need a 15 exercise plan. You need 3. One squat, one push, one pull. This guide gives you the options, the set styles to keep it interesting, and a finisher to cap it off.

HOW IT WORKS: PICK ONE OF EACH

This is not a list of 13 exercises to do in one session. Pick ONE squat, ONE push and ONE pull from the lists on the next page. That's your whole workout: 3 exercises.

Then choose one of the set styles from page 3 and apply it to all 3 exercises. Different exercises and different set styles each session means you can run this for months without it getting boring.

STEP 1: WARM UP (5 TO 8 MINUTES)

Don't skip this. A short warm up means better lifts and fewer niggles. Do it in this order:

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| 1. Raise the heart rate | 3 to 5 minutes easy pace on the treadmill, bike or cross trainer. You should feel warm, not out of breath. |
| 2. Loosen up | 10 arm circles each way, 10 hip circles each way, 10 leg swings per leg. |
| 3. Wake the muscles up | 10 bodyweight squats, 10 incline press ups (hands on a bench or bar), 10 band pull aparts or light rows. |
| 4. Ramp up sets | Do 1 or 2 lighter sets of each of your 3 chosen exercises before your working sets. Roughly 50 percent then 75 percent of your working weight. |

THE SESSION AT A GLANCE

BLOCK	TIME	WHAT YOU'RE DOING
WARM UP	5 to 8 min	Get warm and ramp up to your working weight
3 EXERCISES	25 to 35 min	One squat + one push + one pull, using your chosen set style
FINISHER	10 to 15 min	Treadmill incline walk or stair master for steps and cardio

STEP 2: PICK YOUR 3 EXERCISES

One from each list. Remember: it's 3 exercises total, not 13. If you're unsure, start with the first option in each list. They're the most beginner friendly.

SQUAT (pick 1 of 3)

EXERCISE	WHY IT WORKS
Goblet Squat	Hold a dumbbell at your chest. The weight keeps you balanced and upright, so it almost teaches you the movement. The best starting point.
Leg Press	The machine guides the movement, so it's hard to get wrong. Great if confidence with free weights isn't there yet, and easy to push hard safely.
Barbell Back Squat	The classic. Bar on your upper back, squat to depth. Use this once your goblet squat feels strong and you want to load up.

PUSH (pick 1 of 5)

EXERCISE	WHY IT WORKS
Press Up	No kit needed. Raise your hands onto a bench or bar to make it easier, lower them as you get stronger.
Machine Chest Press	Guided path, easy to set up, easy to load. Ideal for beginners and brilliant for drop sets.
Dumbbell Bench Press	Each arm works on its own, so no hiding a weaker side. Builds chest, shoulders and triceps.
Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press	Pressing overhead instead of forward. The seat supports your back so you can focus on the press.
Barbell Bench Press	The big one. Best saved for when you're confident, and use a spotter or safety bars when going heavy.

PULL (pick 1 of 5)

EXERCISE	WHY IT WORKS
Seated Cable Row	The machine guides you, works your whole back and helps your posture. The perfect beginner pull.
Lat Pulldown	Pull the bar to your upper chest, not behind your neck. Builds the back width that pull ups need.
Single Arm Dumbbell Row	One hand and knee on a bench, row the dumbbell to your hip. Great for fixing left to right imbalances.
Chest Supported Row	Lie chest down on an incline bench and row dumbbells. The bench removes momentum, so your back does all the work.
Assisted Pull Up	Use the assisted machine or a band. Reduce the assistance over time until you've earned a full pull up.

Form rule for everything above: control the lowering part, full range you can manage, and stop the set when your form breaks down, not when your ego does.

STEP 3: PICK YOUR SET STYLE

Pick ONE style per session and use it for all 3 exercises. Rest 90 seconds to 2 minutes between sets unless the style says otherwise.

1. PYRAMID SETS **BUILD UP THE WEIGHT**

How it works: Start light with higher reps, then add weight and drop reps each set. You climb the pyramid towards your heaviest set.

Example: Set 1: 12 reps light. Set 2: 10 reps medium. Set 3: 8 reps heavier. Set 4: 6 reps heaviest. 4 sets per exercise.

2. REVERSE PYRAMID **HEAVIEST FIRST**

How it works: The opposite. After your warm up sets, do your heaviest set first while you're fresh, then strip weight off and add reps each set.

Example: Set 1: 6 reps heavy. Set 2: 8 reps with about 10 percent less. Set 3: 10 reps with another 10 percent off. 3 sets per exercise.

3. DROP SETS **EMPTY THE TANK**

How it works: Do a set close to failure, then immediately drop the weight by 20 to 30 percent and keep going without rest. Drop twice. Works brilliantly on machines and dumbbells.

Example: Machine chest press: 10 reps, drop the pin, 8 more reps, drop again, as many as you can. That's one drop set. Do 2 per exercise.

4. CLUSTER SETS **HEAVY WEIGHT, MORE REPS**

How it works: Break one heavy set into mini sets with short rests inside it. The mini rests let you handle heavier weight for more total reps than one straight set would allow.

Example: Pick a weight you could lift 6 times. Do 3 reps, rest 20 seconds, 3 reps, rest 20 seconds, 3 reps. That's one cluster of 9 reps. Rest 2 minutes, repeat for 3 clusters.

5. REST PAUSE **BEAT YOUR NUMBER**

How it works: One set to near failure, rest just 15 seconds, squeeze out more reps, rest 15 seconds, go one final time. Three efforts, one weight.

Example: Lat pulldown: 12 reps, 15 seconds rest, 5 more, 15 seconds rest, 3 more. That's 20 total. Do 2 rounds per exercise.

6. LADDER SETS **RACE THE CLOCK**

How it works: Pick a light to medium weight. Climb reps each round with minimal rest: 2 reps, then 4, then 6, then 8, then 10. Finished the ladder? Rest 2 minutes and see if you can do it again.

Example: Goblet squat ladder: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10 reps with 20 seconds between rungs. 30 reps per ladder, 2 ladders per exercise.

7. EMOM **EVERY MINUTE ON THE MINUTE**

How it works: Set a 10 minute timer. At the top of every minute do your reps, then rest whatever is left of that minute. Faster reps means more rest. Simple and brutal.

Example: Minute 1: 8 squats. Minute 2: 8 pushes. Minute 3: 8 pulls. Repeat that 3 exercise cycle until the 10 minutes are up. One EMOM covers your whole session.

STEP 4: THE FINISHER

Lifting builds the strength. This bit looks after your heart, burns a few extra calories and tops up your step count. Pick one:

OPTION	TIME	HOW TO DO IT
TREADMILL INCLINE WALK	10 to 15 min	Set the incline to 8 to 12 percent and walk at a pace where you can talk but wouldn't want to sing. No holding the rails.
STAIR MASTER	10 min	Steady pace, full steps, stand tall. If 10 minutes feels too much, start with 5 and add a minute each week.
TREADMILL INTERVALS	10 min	1 minute brisk, 1 minute easy, repeated 5 times. A good shout if you find steady cardio boring.

EXAMPLE SESSIONS

SESSION	YOUR 3 EXERCISES	SET STYLE	FINISHER
WEEK 1, SESSION 1	Goblet Squat + Machine Chest Press + Seated Cable Row	Pyramid Sets	Incline walk 12 min
WEEK 1, SESSION 2	Leg Press + Press Up + Lat Pulldown	EMOM	Stair master 8 min
WEEK 2, SESSION 1	Goblet Squat + Dumbbell Bench Press + Single Arm Row	Drop Sets	Incline walk 15 min
WEEK 2, SESSION 2	Barbell Back Squat + Shoulder Press + Assisted Pull Up	Cluster Sets	Intervals 10 min

THE RULES

- Do this 2 or 3 times a week. Consistency beats intensity every single time.
- Pick ONE squat, ONE push, ONE pull per session. Never all of them.
- Change the set style before you change the exercises. That's where the variety lives.
- When you can hit the top of a rep range with good form, add a little weight next time.
- Track it. Write down your exercises, weights and set style so next session has a number to beat.

WANT A HAND GETTING STARTED?

If you're new to the gym, nervous about it, or coming back after a long break, this is exactly who I work with.

Message me the word START on Instagram @fitnessbyksr or visit www.fitnessbyksr.co.uk and I'll sort you out.